Generated from the competition table

1997 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1997, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner	National team	Ceremony date
Ronaldo	Brazil	23 December 1997

The story of this edition

Ronaldo (Brazil) is the Ballon d'Or's youngest-ever winner, aged 21 when he won in 1997.

← Previous edition (PDF)
1996

Next edition (PDF) →
1998

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →

📚 References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed:29 October 2026

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- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 2 of 3) (https://www.goal.com/en/news/ballon-d-or-2026-bukayo-saka-wins-the-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work/blt56fa02ceffa40d5f)
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- 2023 UEFA Nations League Player of the Finals - UEFA's own site (source 1 of 2) (https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0282-1849de0ccdfe-e28eb8d71909-1000--rodri-named-2023-uefa-nations-league-player-of-the-finals)

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- 2024 UEFA EURO Player of the Tournament - already independently (https://businessday.ng/sports/article/euro-2024-rodri-wins-best-player-of-the-tournament)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.